



MONTHLY UPDATE

Regional collaboration: monthly update, August 2026

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39 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CHAD · CONGO ·
COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LIBERIA
· LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA ·
SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO ·
TUNISIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

Algeria [signed as a founding member of a world artificial-intelligence organisation at Shanghai on 16 July](#), the digitalisation commissioner stating an intention to take an active role. The organisation is not named in anything held, and no accord text, ratification step or work programme is on file.

Angola

The national satellite began earning its keep across the border. Mozambique's state operator [started proof-of-concept testing of the Angolan satellite for providing telecommunications services in Mozambique](#), announced by the Angolan telecommunications ministry as a step towards a commercial agreement to distribute communication and broadcasting signals over Angolan space infrastructure. It follows the Mozambican public broadcaster's own proof of concept, implements a bilateral memorandum signed in June 2026, and runs in parallel with a commercial pilot with a Namibian operator for satellite-driven backhaul. No commercial terms are published.

Benin

The cross-border digital identity work Benin does through Smart Africa moved from development into a running pilot: [an identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two](#), with eighteen further countries said to be joining and no date given for any of them.

Botswana

The [ICT memorandum with Namibia was signed at Kasane on 7 August](#) between the two ICT ministries, with their operators and regulators present, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development. It had been [announced for signature the day before](#) as an extension of existing roaming and submarine-cable transit cooperation. The signed instrument itself is not held, and no term, funding or data-governance provision is published; what the two sides did publish alongside it is operational, and is recorded under connectivity below.

Burkina Faso

The region's answer to a network that keeps being attacked is another country's fibre. At a meeting of the two digital ministers on 12 August, [Nigeria proposed connecting its planned 90,000 km open-access national fibre network to Burkina Faso's borders to improve internet resilience, quality and affordability, alongside cooperation on artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure and talent](#). Both halves of that are prospective: the corridor is a proposal, and the Nigerian network it would reach is itself planned rather than built.

Burundi

Two regional processes opened and neither has a text. A technical team [agreed on 3 August, during the continental free-trade secretariat's mission to Bujumbura, to produce a country profile and an implementation roadmap, and consultation was held in Bujumbura on a memorandum for cross-border health-security cooperation with the regional authority](#). Neither carries a signature, a date or a funding line.

Cameroon

The region began drafting the rules for moving data across its own borders, in this country's second city. Experts from Central African member states [met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September to assess national readiness and agree the pillars of a regional framework on cross-border data governance, with technical and financial support from the German development agency, a continental development agency, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission](#). Pillars are all that is agreed: no draft text, adoption route or timetable is published.

Chad

The telecommunications minister [received an Azerbaijani delegation in N'Djamena to explore e-government cooperation](#). Nothing is agreed, and no memorandum, scope or value is on file.

Congo

The broadcasting regulator and its counterpart across the river [signed a memorandum formalising their partnership after two days of work on 19 and 20 August](#). No text, scope or commencement is published, so what the base holds is that two regulators have agreed to cooperate.

Cote d'Ivoire

Côte d'Ivoire is standing for a seat at the table that writes the rules. It [declared its candidacy for election to the ITU Council and will press it at the 7th World Telecommunication/ICT Policy Forum in Nassau, with a delegation attending the forum to prepare that candidacy](#). The record held names no platform the candidacy would run on and no other state's support for it.

DR Congo

The [African Telecommunications Union's return to Kinshasa was ratified on 23 July at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja, after the country paid more than US\\$1.4m in arrears](#). No date for the move is stated, the arrears figure and the account are the minister's own, and a bid for a seat on the ITU's administrative council for 2027 to 2030 is still pending.

Eswatini

The King was [elected Chairperson of the SADC Organ on Politics, Defence and Security Cooperation](#) at the bloc's 46th summit in Durban on 17 August. It is a security portfolio, not a digital one, and no ICT or data responsibility attaches to it in the communique.

A second regional channel opened alongside the SADC one. The Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general [met the ICT minister on cooperation to accelerate digital transformation, the country presenting 1.76m mobile connections against a population of about 1.3m and 95% fourth-generation coverage](#). These are exploratory talks with no memorandum, work programme or membership step recorded, and the connection and coverage figures are the government's own.

Ethiopia

The regional transit corridor moved from agreement to build. Ethio telecom [entered active deployment of the Horizon Fiber Initiative, with end-to-end solution architecture finalised and site-material procurement complete](#), on a multi-terabit terrestrial route linking Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia and Sudan to Jeddah. No route length, capacity, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published, so the regional-hub claim rests on the geography alone — and one of the four territories the route crosses is at war.

Gabon

Two outward moves in the same week, one to learn and one to be heard. An interior, security and decentralisation ministry delegation [spent nearly two weeks in Rwanda on digital transformation and e-governance, artificial intelligence and digital policy, civil-registration and identification digitisation, cybersecurity, data protection, interconnection of public systems and decentralised service digitisation](#) - the longest and widest-ranging of eight delegations the host received that week. Separately the digital economy minister [presented the country's candidacy for the International Telecommunication Union Council in Nassau on 3 September, under the slogan Shaping the Digital Future](#). Neither carries an agreement, an adoption decision or a campaign platform beyond the slogan.

Gambia

The revenue authority [hosted the seventh ATAF Heads of Tax Administrations Master Class in Banjul on 23-24 July 2026](#). The Forum's executive secretary argued from Rwanda, Kenya and Morocco that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform — "technology alone collects nothing" — and [pressed for a united African position at the United Nations](#).

The bilateral channel that bears on connectivity moved from signature to work. The June 2026 telecommunications and digital-economy memorandum with Senegal [went into implementation around four priorities — connectivity, cybersecurity, skills and digital transformation — with the Senegalese telecommunications and digital minister travelling to Banjul to agree the first joint work, the two regulators having separately deepened cooperation on frequency coordination, service quality and cross-border roaming](#). The structural case for it is the country's own: a limited terrestrial fibre build and dependence on a single submarine cable for international access, with only limited terrestrial redundancy through Senegal. No work programme, budget or timetable is published. That work took its first steering-committee session at [Banjul on 29 August 2026](#), where the four priorities were settled as infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation, with rural electronic-government access named among them. No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four.

Ghana

Ghana's regional position moved on three fronts, none of them with a text attached. African Union ministers [endorsed continental roll-out of the illicit-financial-flows policy tracker](#) from the six-country pilot Ghana ran over eighteen months, the finance ministry reporting that it contributed to recovering millions of dollars in revenue — with no Ghana-specific score, finding or reform list published. The communications ministry [announced a partnership on digital-policy intelligence and regulatory-analysis tools](#) at an Accra workshop on 10 August, covering the national AI strategy, data-governance work and the coders programme, with no funding, duration or deliverables stated. And the [fintech licence passporting memorandum with Rwanda remains unpublished by either central bank](#) eighteen months after signature, so which licence categories are recognised, and on what conditions, is still unestablished.

A fourth front does have something running. A continental alliance and a German development agency say [a digital identity issued in Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining](#). No scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated.

Guinea

Guinea took the presidency of the regional audiovisual regulators' platform on 31 August, when the [12th General Assembly of the platform of the eight monetary-union states and Guinea opened in Conakry and its leadership passed to the head of the national communications authority](#). The two-day agenda was harmonising the legal and technical tools for regulating social platforms against cybersecurity and social-cohesion risks, AI-generated disinformation and deepfakes among them, and strengthening the standing of regulators over those platforms. Opening it, the Justice Minister argued for a framework that ["protects without stifling, regulates without censoring"](#) and called cybersecurity a question of sovereignty rather than a technical one. What the record holds is a presidency and an agenda: no harmonised instrument, timetable or funding is announced.

Kenya

The continental data convention still has no Kenyan signature behind it, but the base can now say why. A policy brief prepared for the accession process records that [Kenya has neither signed nor ratified the Malabo Convention, that the Cabinet approved a process step towards accession in September 2025, that the data protection commissioner then led national consultations closing 6 October 2025, and that the Attorney-General had cleared the Convention before the process stalled twice on cabinet reshuffles](#); twenty African Union member states had ratified as at March 2026. A [high-level parliamentary dialogue on accession was called for 7 September 2026](#). What has moved is the process, not the treaty position, and no instrument of accession is on the record. A peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries [records only Rwanda as a signatory and finds all four frameworks fragmented, with weak harmonisation of cross-border transfers and capacity gaps](#).

Liberia

At the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary session in Abuja in July, Liberia [negotiated a waiver of US\\$361,151.36 in arrears dating back to 1982, deposited its instrument of ratification and had its voting rights restored](#).

Libya

On 26 July a delegation from the communications authority [attended the African Telecommunications Union's 7th Plenipotentiary Conference in Abuja](#) and held bilateral meetings to seek support for Libya's candidacy for membership of the ITU Council.

On 1 August the executive bureau of the Council of Arab Ministers of Communications and Information, meeting in Tunisia, [recorded Libya as chair of the Arab working group on AI Data and Digital Infrastructure](#), one of six groups under the Arab Permanent Committee on Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies.

On 15 August, on the margins of ARABOSAI's fiftieth-anniversary ceremony in Amman, Libya's Audit Bureau and Tunisia's Court of Auditors [signed a roadmap to activate an existing cooperation agreement](#), covering exchange of expertise, capacity building, development of digital systems and solutions, and cooperation on artificial intelligence and its governance. No phase dates, budget or workplan is published.

Madagascar

Madagascar attached itself to three external arrangements in twelve days, none of which it wrote. The Council of Ministers [approved joining a China-initiated international network against cybercrime on 4 August](#), mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public-security, digital-development and gendarmerie ministries for cross-border cooperation on online fraud; no founding text, membership list, data-sharing rule or safeguard on what is exchanged is held.

Around 15 August it also [signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and joined the World AI Cooperation Organization](#), the account citing Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity. An [editorial the same week](#) frames the turn toward Beijing on fraud as inseparable from the country's digital-transformation and investment ambitions. None of the three is evidenced by an instrument the base holds, and the country still has no national artificial-intelligence strategy of its own.

Malawi

Regional work was two conversations. The minister [urged the regional bloc to target artificial-intelligence investment at a Lilongwe workshop](#), and a delegation [visited Accra to discuss digital-government cooperation with Ghana](#). Neither carries a memorandum, funding figure or timetable.

Mali

On 24 July Mali was [re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board for 2027-2031](#) at the Abuja plenipotentiary.

The same 1 August recommendations also included [a protocol between AES states to harmonise AI governance](#).

Mauritius

The continental internet registry seated here is still without a settled board. One outlet's analysis records that the registry [named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised](#), and that the appeal court has now [set aside its 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the official receiver's permission or on statutory leave](#). The chain from election through appointment to quorum is therefore unresolved and the receiver undischarged. No registry statement on the withheld tallies is held.

Morocco

Morocco's regional reach extended past the continent this month: the UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia and the minister for digital transition [signed a memorandum in Rabat establishing a framework for regional cooperation on modernising public administration and advancing digital governance reform](#). No programme, value or deliverable is attached to it.

Namibia

The memorandum with Botswana was signed. The two ICT ministries [signed at Kasane on 7 August, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development](#), and published detail with it: [the Trans-Kalahari Corridor's remaining 4G gaps costed at about N\\$52 million across 13 new sites, and the Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link completed and interconnecting with the Botswana backbone company at Charles Hill](#), the first direct cross-border fibre link between the two operators. The signed instrument itself is not held.

Four lighter engagements ran alongside. Cabinet approved a memorandum on information technology cooperation with [the Republic of Congo, authorising the minister to sign without publishing scope, financing or a signature date](#). Namibia joined four other governments as a founding partner of [a pan-African African-language artificial-intelligence initiative launched at Abuja on 24 July](#), committing ministerial support rather than a named contribution. The fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi on 12 August advanced cybersecurity and digital-economy cooperation with India. The regional regulators' association opened its legal and policy committee at Windhoek from 10 to 12 August, on artificial-intelligence governance, data governance, digital public infrastructure and regulatory harmonisation, and the communications regulator [signed a five-year memorandum with the electricity distributor at Ondangwa on information and data sharing and rural electrification](#). None of the five publishes a work programme, term or timetable.

Niger

On 30 July a Nigerien technical mission led by the interior ministry's secretary-general was [received in Ouagadougou to study Burkina Faso's identification machinery](#) — the civil-status modernisation directorate, the national identification office, the ICT agency and the WURI project. The delegation covered civil registration, migration, the digital agency, territorial surveillance, biometric-card production, the interior ministry's legal service and the ICT and finance ministries, and reported recommendations on issuing authentic documents and limiting document fraud.

Nigeria

Ministers adopted an Abuja declaration on meaningful connectivity.

The continental data convention still has no Nigerian signature behind it: a peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries [records only Rwanda as a signatory, and finds all four frameworks fragmented with weak harmonisation of cross-border transfers](#). That is a finding about the record, carried as a dated absence.

The second meeting of the Africa Public Key Infrastructure Forum, held in Abuja, [called for harmonised African rules so that digital credentials, electronic signatures and documents can be verified across borders](#). Nothing was adopted, and the base holds no instrument, timetable or signatory list behind the call.

Rwanda

Country consultations for a [regional artificial-intelligence framework were held at Kigali on 3 August](#), to feed a study toward a regional strategy, model policy guidelines and model regulatory frameworks; no text or timetable is published, and Rwanda reported unquantified progress on its own national policy. The [bilateral licence passporting memorandum with Ghana remains unpublished by either central bank](#) eighteen months after signature, cited as a working precedent with no firm reported as having used it.

One piece of regional machinery moved from design into use. A continental alliance and a German development agency say [a digital identity issued in Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining](#). No scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated for any of it.

Senegal

Regionally, Senegal became [one of 29 founding states of an intergovernmental artificial-intelligence governance body on 16 July](#), and joined the approval on 31 July of [three regional statistical methodological guides](#).

The bilateral channel moved from signature to work. The June memorandum with the Gambia took its [first steering-committee session at Banjul on 29 August 2026](#), where four priorities were settled — infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation — with rural electronic-government access named among them. What Senegal supplies in that relationship is transit: the Gambia depends largely on a single submarine cable, with only limited terrestrial redundancy through Senegal. No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four.

Seychelles

The regional framework Seychelles harmonises through was republished rather than changed. The SADC Secretariat issued [the consolidated text of the Treaty as amended, naming Seychelles among the founding High Contracting Parties and setting out the Community's institutions, its areas of co-operation and the Protocol mechanism](#) in August 2026. No ratification instrument for any digital or data protocol under that mechanism is on the record, so what the window adds is the frame and not a step inside it.

Sierra Leone

Regional health data gained an institutional seat. The health minister [attended the inaugural board meeting of the Health Intelligence Centres for Africa in Addis Ababa with the head of the national health information hub, Sierra Leone being a founding member and sitting on the strategic advisory board](#). Founding membership is a position the base can state; what it cannot yet state is what the body will do with member states' health data, since no constitutive instrument, budget or data-sharing arrangement is published.

Somalia

Accession to the continental free-trade area reached its last procedural step: the [instrument of ratification is to be deposited in September 2026](#), with a first shipment named as the test that follows it. No implementation roadmap, tariff schedule or customs-systems requirement is published alongside it.

South Africa

Regional cooperation moved from documents to a stated test this month. The higher education minister [told a regional vice-chancellors' meeting in Johannesburg on 31 August that the region must build its own computing capability, trusted datasets, African-language technologies and cybersecurity rather than rent intelligence from others](#), setting agreement on a regional higher education data system among five immediate priorities. The test he named is the useful part: by the June 2027 ministers' meeting the region should be able to point to students and academics who have moved and to data being shared, not to completed documents. [The meeting's own message was the same](#) - build the practical systems that let qualifications, research and skills cross borders. No design, host, funding or data scope is stated for the data system.

South Sudan

The one regional move in the window is a pledge without a workplan. On 12 August the minister [visited the African Telecommunications Union's Nairobi headquarters and pledged deeper collaboration on infrastructure, capacity building and standardisation](#). No workplan, contribution or membership status is stated, and it sits alongside the payment-system bill validated the same month with East African Community and Bank of Uganda backing — the substantive regional support in this record runs through that bill rather than through the union.

Tanzania

Tanzania was the one being studied this month. A Somali government delegation [examined the labour and employment digital systems in Dodoma on 28 August](#), and Somalia is [seeking to learn from the wider public-service digitalisation experience](#). Both accounts are the host's. Nothing in the record held sets out what is to be transferred, on what terms, or whether either side has committed anything beyond a visit.

Togo

A [regional dialogue at the Togo-Ghana joint border post on 13 August sought to accelerate free movement along the Abidjan-Lagos corridor, reaffirming rollout of the regional biometric identity card and the interconnected transit system to cut border delays](#). No deployment figure, timetable or data-protection arrangement for the shared border and transit data is stated,.

Tunisia

Tunisia chairs and convenes rather than signs. It [was elected chair of the Arab League's working group on artificial-intelligence innovation and technological solutions at the permanent committee's inaugural meeting in Tunis](#), and [hosted the ninth Arab conference of directors of nationality and civil-status departments, which closed in Tunis on 19 August](#). Neither carries a work programme, a decision or a text on the record.

Zimbabwe

A Rwandan immigration delegation toured two border posts on 29 July under a 2024 bilateral memorandum ([visit account](#)).

Harare then hosted the regional attempt to write common rules for the thing all these systems run on. Southern African regulators, data-protection authorities and artificial-intelligence task forces [met for a three-day workshop to harmonise national data-governance rules](#), anchored to the African Union data policy framework, a continental data governance blueprint, the regional data strategy and a UNESCO toolkit, with the convening body noting that only 1% of data-centre capacity sits within Africa. No outcome document, commitment or timetable from it is held.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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